**Landscape Architecture**
PLACEmaking Team

Development Management Consultation Response
Date: 15.02.22

Officer: Charles Potterton

| Reference: | Site: | Proposal: | Case Officer: |
|---|---|---|---|
| *S/COND/22/0031* | *South Marston* | *Design Code* | ***Ed Snook*** |

**Summary of Landscape response**

| | |
|---|---|
| - No Comment/No Objection | ☐ |
| - No Objection/ Subject to conditions | ☐ |
| - Not acceptable in its current format/subject to changes described below | ☒ |
| - Objection in principle | ☐ |

**Executive Summary**

Thank you for consulting the Landscape Section of the PLACEmaking Team.

**Full Comments**

Whilst the document is improving as it emerges, there are still some areas that need to be addressed. In no particular order –

1. Relationship with Nightingale Wood. On plan this looks very harsh and is, in effect a straight line with (according to the cross sections) only 20m between the actual houses and the edge of the woodland. This is an uncomfortable relationship that needs to be reviewed.

2. There is opportunity to extend fingers of woodland out into the proposed scheme.

3. The headings under 'opportunities for enhancement' are worthy but need to be properly reflected in the associated plans. The numbering system on these plans is not helpful.

4. The scheme needs to take proper account of how the Forestry Commission might want to secure their boundary. What if they want to erect a secure fence ?

5. The cross sections (throughout the document) are still quite diagrammatic. I understand the need to avoid committing to some areas of detail, but the swales need to be illustrated as a depression and not a green triangle.

6. More detail is required in respect of tree planting across the whole site, especially around sizes of trees for the various street types – we need to know more about size of tree (at planting) and spacing.

Swindon Borough Council

7. We have already asked for lengths of avenue planting to be included within the scheme. Whilst we do not want avenues everywhere, we do need some where it is appropriate. I note that avenues of tree planting are shown on the plans at p97, 108, 111 and 113 for example, yet the word 'avenue' is not used anywhere in the report.

8. I suggest we need a specific 'chapter' dealing with tree planting as this is a fundamental part of the scheme which needs to be agreed now. We need to have a set of agreed principles and strategies around what size of tree gets planted in any given scenario. This could be presented in a tabular fashion (bolstered with the cross-sectional information) using the broad headings already in use – primary, secondary and tertiary streets, open space areas, woodland edge, etc etc.

9. The cross sections are useful, but we do need more detail. They seem to include more detail on the size and type of bench to be used and this does seem to be out of proportion with their relative importance.

Overall, the actual footprint is emerging well and there are positive elements but the detail around tree planting needs more work.

Charles Potterton
15.02.2022